

August 2026

Dear Homeowner,

I've worked Lamorinda and the surrounding Contra Costa communities long enough to recognize a well-cared-for home the moment I see one, and 1489 Sunnybrook Rd. caught my attention right away. The combination of a single-story footprint, a saltwater pool, and that kind of meticulous top-to-bottom update work is genuinely uncommon at any price point, let alone in West Alamo. When the listing came off market after just 22 days without a sale, I wanted to understand why, and I think I have a clear picture.

Twenty-two days is short enough that most sellers assume the market simply wasn't ready, but in my experience that window is exactly when the right strategy matters most. At \$917 per square foot on a 1949 home, even one with serious upgrades, buyers need to feel the full case before they'll commit at that number. The listing description threw a lot at the wall, and some of the strongest selling points, the smart-home lighting, the commercial-grade range, the indoor-outdoor pool setting, got buried in a list of features rather than being built into a narrative that connected the home's character to what West Alamo buyers are actually looking for. The home has real substance. The marketing didn't quite build the brief for it.

I've put together a short packet for you that walks through the three specific friction points I see in the listing history, a side-by-side look at where \$917 per square foot sits in the Alamo market today, and the approach I'd take to relaunch this home with a strategy designed around its actual strengths rather than a standard MLS playbook.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside with my best wishes. If you're not, I'd genuinely enjoy a short conversation about what a relaunch could look like.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

1489 Sunnybrook Rd.

Alamo, CA 94507

3.0 Beds · 2 Baths · 2,178 Sq Ft · Alamo

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 1489 Sunnybrook Rd.

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Meticulously Updated West Alamo Single-Story - and a Listing That Didn't Build the Case for It

1489 Sunnybrook Rd. offers something that is genuinely hard to find in Alamo: a fully updated single-story home on a private lot with a saltwater pool, smart-home systems, a commercial-grade kitchen, and mature landscaping that creates real indoor-outdoor living. The 2,178 square feet of living space is sensibly distributed for both everyday use and entertaining, and the scope of recent improvements, new flooring, new exterior and interior paint, new pavers, Lutron smart-lighting throughout, a resurfaced driveway, and a thermostatically-controlled fireplace in the primary suite, signals a move-in-ready home that a busy professional or relocating family can step into without a project list.

The listing history doesn't match those fundamentals. At \$1,998,000 and \$917 per square foot on a 1949 footprint, this home sits at the upper edge of the Alamo standard tier and needs marketing that builds the case for that number clearly and early. The listing description leads with caps-heavy fragments and a sequential feature list rather than a story, and it never frames the specific combination of location, condition, and lifestyle that separates this property from newer construction at a lower price per square foot. Buyers comparing options at this level need to feel why the number is right before they schedule a showing. That story was there. It just wasn't told.

\$1,998,000

List Price

\$917/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to do one thing above all else: make the premium legible. That means building the narrative around what this specific home delivers, single-story living, a private pool setting, smart-home infrastructure, and a West Alamo address with top schools, in a way that arms buyers with the rationale to justify \$917 per square foot against every other option they're considering.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: Narrative Failure - A Strong Home Described as a Feature List

The listing description for 1489 Sunnybrook Rd. reads as an inventory of improvements rather than a case for the home. All-caps fragments like 'WEST ALAMO w/TOP ALAMO SCHOOLS' and 'SALT WATER POOL' pull attention without grounding the buyer in the experience of living there. Details worth real money, the Lutron Casita smart-lighting system, the commercial-grade gas range, the thermostatically-controlled fireplace in the primary suite, are dropped mid-list rather than anchored to the lifestyle a buyer at \$1,998,000 is actually imagining. At this price point, buyers are comparing carefully, and a description that reads like a form submission gets scrolled past. This home had a story worth telling, and it still does.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's listing remarks are written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home to a client, specific, sequential, and emotionally grounded. Paired with Zillow Showcase placement, the narrative reaches buyers at the exact moment they're deciding whether to schedule a showing.

Friction #2: Premium Not Justified in Marketing - \$917/sqft on a 1949 Footprint

At \$917 per square foot, 1489 Sunnybrook Rd. is priced at the top of the Alamo standard tier and at the entry point of the premium tier. That number is defensible, the scope of updates, the saltwater pool, the smart-home infrastructure, the single-story layout on a private lot, absolutely support it. But buyers comparing this home against newer construction at \$850 to \$950 per square foot need to understand specifically what they're getting here that they can't find elsewhere at this price. Without a marketing approach that builds that case visually and narratively before a showing, price-conscious buyers move on before they ever walk through the door.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk every room of the home from anywhere, at any time, so they arrive at a showing already understanding the floor plan, the scale, and the finish level, with the confidence to justify the number before they ever step inside.

Friction #3: Visual Story Never Told - A Saltwater Pool Setting Left to Imagination

The backyard at 1489 Sunnybrook Rd., irrigated lush landscaping, a saltwater pool, private fencing, and new pavers, is exactly the kind of California indoor-outdoor setting that moves buyers in the Alamo market. That setting lives or dies on photography. Standard MLS angles rarely capture the relationship between a pool, the surrounding landscape, and the home itself in a way that communicates the lifestyle rather than just documenting the amenity. A buyer scrolling listings at \$1,998,000 needs to feel the backyard before they schedule a showing. Without the right visual, a saltwater pool registers as a checkbox rather than a reason to buy.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour places the lot, the pool setting, the landscaping, and the street presence in full aerial context, giving online buyers the spatial understanding that ground photography simply cannot replicate.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	1489 Sunnybrook Rd.	Alamo Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$917/sqft	Standard tier: \$850–\$950/sqft Premium tier: \$950–\$1,100/sqft
Lot / Setting	10,608 sq. ft. private lot with saltwater pool and mature landscaping	Typical Alamo lot: 8,000–12,000 sq. ft., pool lots command premium
Architectural Character	1949 single-story, fully updated, move-in ready condition	Mix of original and updated mid-century single-story inventory
Premium Features	Lutron smart-lighting, commercial-grade range, thermostatically-controlled fireplace, epoxy garage, resurfaced driveway	Standard inventory typically offers one or two major upgrades, not a full-scope renovation
HOA	None	Most West Alamo single-family homes carry no HOA

The verdict: At \$917/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$950/sqft, this home sits near the upper end of that range. At \$917 per square foot, 1489 Sunnybrook Rd. sits at the upper edge of the Alamo standard tier, a number the home's condition and amenities can support, but one that required marketing built to make the case. The full-scope renovation, the saltwater pool setting, and the smart-home infrastructure together justify the position, but buyers at this level need that argument laid out for them clearly and early. The gap here was not in the home. It was in the strategy.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Building the Narrative That Earns \$917 Per Square Foot

At this price point in Alamo, buyers are doing serious homework before they schedule a showing. The listing remarks for 1489 Sunnybrook Rd. need to lead with the experience of living here, single-story ease, a private pool setting, a smart-home kitchen, a primary suite that functions as a real retreat, not a sequential list of upgrades. BrightWork rewrites the story from the buyer's perspective, so the number feels earned before they ever visit. The right narrative doesn't just describe a home. It makes the case for it.

Pillar II - Showing the Backyard the Way It Deserves to Be Seen

The saltwater pool, the irrigated landscaping, the new pavers and fencing, these are premium selling points that require premium visual treatment. A Sky Tour places the entire outdoor setting in context, capturing the lot position, the pool, and the relationship between the backyard and the home in a way that no ground-level photograph can. Buyers who have already experienced the backyard visually arrive at showings prepared to fall in love with it in person, not discovering it for the first time at the front door.

Pillar III - Reaching the Right Buyer Before They Find Something Else

The buyer for 1489 Sunnybrook Rd. is likely a busy professional or relocating family, possibly coming from San Francisco or the East Bay, who is shopping Alamo online before committing to a weekend of showings. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns put this home in front of those buyers while they are still in the research phase, before they have narrowed their list to homes from agents who waited for them to come to the MLS. A 22-day window with no sale is a distribution problem as much as anything else. The right buyer was out there. The listing just didn't reach them.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1-2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4-5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6-7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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